

Linux Troubleshooting with TUI Tools

Logs • System Health • Disk

PROBLEM

While troubleshooting Linux servers, I was jumping between different commands to check logs, services, CPU, memory, and disk usage. It was taking more time than I wanted.

HOW I DEBUGGED IT

I started trying a few TUI tools to get a quick view of what was happening on the server.

This made it easier to investigate logs, system health, and disk usage directly from the terminal.

THE SOLUTION

These tools helped me spot service errors and resource issues faster. I could see more information in one place instead of switching between multiple commands. It made my Linux troubleshooting workflow much simpler and faster.

Linux Issue → Check Logs & System Health → TUI Tools → Identify the Problem → Fix

Have you faced a similar problem?

What tools or commands do you use for Linux troubleshooting?

How did you fix it?

Blog:<https://vishnusai.hashnode.dev/linux-troubleshooting-with-tui-tools-logs-system-health-disk>

HashnodProfile:<https://hashnode.com/@vishnusaiK>

GitHub : <https://github.com/ksaivishnusaikvs>

Lnav: **lnav** What I like about lnav

Search & filter logs quickly — find errors, warnings, and specific events without chaining multiple commands.

Easy log navigation — work with timestamps and follow live logs in an interactive terminal UI.

One place for troubleshooting — combines many common log-viewing tasks into a simple TUI instead of switching between grep, tail, awk, and less.

lnav file = analyze log files; helps you investigate those logs interactively.

journalctl | lnav = analyze systemd journal logs; get the Nginx service logs.

Problem	Command	What It Solves
Service Failing	journalctl -u nginx.service lnav	Investigate systemd service errors
Container Issue	docker logs nginx 2>&1 lnav	Investigate container logs
Live Container Issue	docker logs -f nginx 2>&1 lnav	Watch errors as they happen
Application Issue	lnav /var/log/nginx/access.log	Analyze a specific log file

```
2026-08-08T03:02:21 UTC
Aug 17 15:29:47 ip-172-31-36-199 dockerd[1134]: time="2026-08-17T15:29:47.929097452Z" level=info msg="Container failed to exit within 10s of signal 15 - using the force"
Aug 17 15:29:47 ip-172-31-36-199 dockerd[1134]: time="2026-08-17T15:29:47.929212102Z" level=info msg="stopping restart-manager" container=909199ae29b4b033d2741e4f52alc9d3
Aug 17 15:29:47 ip-172-31-36-199 dockerd[1134]: time="2026-08-17T15:29:47.929219579Z" level=info msg="Container failed to exit within 10s of signal 15 - using the force"
Aug 17 15:29:47 ip-172-31-36-199 dockerd[1134]: time="2026-08-17T15:29:47.929232322Z" level=info msg="stopping restart-manager" container=b64c3f213b2ac3a9e27c3ee18119193e
Aug 17 15:29:47 ip-172-31-36-199 dockerd[1134]: time="2026-08-17T15:29:47.943276173Z" level=info msg="Container failed to exit within 10s of signal 15 - using the force"
Aug 17 15:29:47 ip-172-31-36-199 dockerd[1134]: time="2026-08-17T15:29:47.951296445Z" level=info msg="received task-delete event from containerd" container=8d7a344b7dd50b
Aug 17 15:29:47 ip-172-31-36-199 dockerd[1134]: time="2026-08-17T15:29:47.955955948Z" level=info msg="Container failed to exit within 10s of signal 15 - using the force"
Aug 17 15:29:47 ip-172-31-36-199 dockerd[1134]: time="2026-08-17T15:29:47.955989476Z" level=info msg="stopping restart-manager" container=197a675287225cafa1e9515ce3aa523f
Aug 17 15:29:47 ip-172-31-36-199 dockerd[1134]: time="2026-08-17T15:29:47.956103518Z" level=info msg="Container failed to exit within 10s of signal 15 - using the force"
Aug 17 15:29:47 ip-172-31-36-199 dockerd[1134]: time="2026-08-17T15:29:47.956113593Z" level=info msg="stopping restart-manager" container=8a4c88f73ca0582a3275e2f2a7c28d1
Aug 17 15:29:47 ip-172-31-36-199 dockerd[1134]: time="2026-08-17T15:29:47.956588357Z" level=info msg="Container failed to exit within 10s of signal 15 - using the force"
Aug 17 15:29:47 ip-172-31-36-199 dockerd[1134]: time="2026-08-17T15:29:47.956606731Z" level=info msg="stopping restart-manager" container=f2de87d3ebb89bb884b3913937ed56cb
Aug 17 15:29:48 ip-172-31-36-199 dockerd[1134]: time="2026-08-17T15:29:48.048029466Z" level=info msg="received task-delete event from containerd" container=f2de87d3ebb89bb
Aug 17 15:29:48 ip-172-31-36-199 dockerd[1134]: time="2026-08-17T15:29:48.068420578Z" level=info msg="received task-delete event from containerd" container=909199ae29b4b0
Aug 17 15:29:48 ip-172-31-36-199 dockerd[1134]: time="2026-08-17T15:29:48.090533522Z" level=info msg="received task-delete event from containerd" container=197a675287225c
Aug 17 15:29:48 ip-172-31-36-199 dockerd[1134]: time="2026-08-17T15:29:48.166496341Z" level=info msg="received task-delete event from containerd" container=8a4c88f73ca058
Aug 17 15:29:48 ip-172-31-36-199 dockerd[1134]: time="2026-08-17T15:29:48.179407819Z" level=info msg="received task-delete event from containerd" container=b64c3f213b2ac3
Aug 17 15:29:48 ip-172-31-36-199 dockerd[1134]: time="2026-08-17T15:29:48.191494141Z" level=info msg="received task-delete event from containerd" container=de9e0a4f2e272c
Aug 17 15:29:48 ip-172-31-36-199 dockerd[1134]: time="2026-08-17T15:29:48.986755208Z" level=info msg="stopping event stream following graceful shutdown" error="<nil>" mod
Aug 17 15:29:49 ip-172-31-36-199 dockerd[1134]: time="2026-08-17T15:29:49.002371120Z" level=info msg="Daemon shutdown complete"
Aug 17 15:29:49 ip-172-31-36-199 systemd[1]: docker.service: Deactivated successfully.
Aug 17 15:29:49 ip-172-31-36-199 systemd[1]: Stopped docker.service - Docker Application Container Engine.
Aug 17 15:29:49 ip-172-31-36-199 systemd[1]: docker.service: consumed 3min 8.161s CPU time, 231.6M memory peak, 0B memory swap peak.
-- Boot 091fd06f0ca4416b383d8790a6a736e --
Aug 18 08:22:13 ip-172-31-36-199 systemd[1]: Starting docker.service - Docker Application Container Engine...
Aug 18 08:22:14 ip-172-31-36-199 dockerd[1102]: time="2026-08-18T08:22:14.705374012Z" level=info msg="Starting up"
Aug 18 08:22:14 ip-172-31-36-199 dockerd[1102]: time="2026-08-18T08:22:14.710921846Z" level=info msg="OTEL tracing is not configured, using no-op tracer provider"
Aug 18 08:22:14 ip-172-31-36-199 dockerd[1102]: time="2026-08-18T08:22:14.711874649Z" level=info msg="CDI directory does not exist, skipping" dir=/var/run/cdi
Aug 18 08:22:14 ip-172-31-36-199 dockerd[1102]: time="2026-08-18T08:22:14.711960048Z" level=info msg="CDI directory does not exist, skipping" dir=/etc/cdi
Aug 18 08:22:14 ip-172-31-36-199 dockerd[1102]: time="2026-08-18T08:22:14.71297675Z" level=info msg="detected 127.0.0.53 nameserver, assuming system-resolved, so using
Aug 18 08:22:14 ip-172-31-36-199 dockerd[1102]: time="2026-08-18T08:22:14.899410805Z" level=info msg="Creating a containerd client" address=/run/containerd/containerd.soc
Aug 18 08:22:14 ip-172-31-36-199 dockerd[1102]: time="2026-08-18T08:22:14.970047868Z" level=info msg="Loading containers: start."
Aug 18 08:22:15 ip-172-31-36-199 dockerd[1102]: time="2026-08-18T08:22:15.052692479Z" level=info msg="Mtu is disabled"
Aug 18 08:22:15 ip-172-31-36-199 dockerd[1102]: time="2026-08-18T08:22:15.052726833Z" level=info msg="Starting daemon with containerd snapshotter integration enabled"
Aug 18 08:22:15 ip-172-31-36-199 dockerd[1102]: time="2026-08-18T08:22:15.078069788Z" level=info msg="Restoring containers: start."
Aug 18 08:22:15 ip-172-31-36-199 dockerd[1102]: time="2026-08-18T08:22:15.323707181Z" level=info msg="Deleting nftables IPv4 rules" error="running nft: /dev/stdin:1:17-30
Aug 18 08:22:15 ip-172-31-36-199 dockerd[1102]: time="2026-08-18T08:22:15.329118240Z" level=info msg="Deleting nftables IPv6 rules" error="running nft: /dev/stdin:1:18-31
Aug 18 08:22:18 ip-172-31-36-199 dockerd[1102]: time="2026-08-18T08:22:18.595257070Z" level=info msg="sbjoin: gwep4 '-->' 5dc703f6d2aa', gwep6 '-->' e1c5dc703f6d2aa ep=
Press TAB to edit

Syntax Help
Any character [a-b] a or b (?-i) Case-sensitive search Examples
Word character [a-zA-Z_] 0 or 1 a's ($) End of string abc* matches 'ab', 'abc', 'abccc'
Digit [0-9] 0 or more a's (..) Capture \[abc] matches keys=[23], key=abc and captures 123 and abc
White space [ ] 1 more a's (^) Start of string \[abc] matches '[abc]'
Escape character [\\] Not a or b [ab-d] Any of a, b, c, or d (?-i)ABC matches 'ABC' and not 'abc'

Search for: (Press CTRL+j to jump to a previous hit and CTRL+q to abort)
```

tui-logs

tui-logs mainly solves the problem of manually searching through large log files using multiple Linux commands.

What it solves

- Too many logs → quickly search and filter the logs you need. Hard to troubleshoot errors → easily find errors, warnings, and related events.
- Live-log monitoring → watch new logs in real time from one interactive terminal.
- Too many commands → reduces the need to switch between **cat**, **grep**, **tail**, **less**, and **awk**.

```
tui-logs journalctl - everything
journal: open entries: 500 on disk: 2.5G follow: every 2s backend: journald 255
[1 entries] 2 stats 3 storage
TIME PRI SOURCE MESSAGE
Sep 08 03:51:43 info agent-i.service 2026/09/08 03:51:43 exporter: endpoint recovered, resuming normal delivery
Sep 08 03:51:43 info agent-i.service 2026/09/08 03:51:43 export error (source=container.blockio.io_service_bytes...
Sep 08 03:51:43 info agent-i.service 2026/09/08 03:51:43 exporter: circuit breaker opened after otel export: 1 o...
Sep 08 03:51:42 info agent-i.service 2026/09/08 03:51:42 exporter: endpoint recovered, resuming normal delivery
Sep 08 03:51:42 info agent-i.service 2026/09/08 03:51:42 export error (source=container.cpu.usage.kernelmode): o...
Sep 08 03:51:42 info agent-i.service 2026/09/08 03:51:42 exporter: circuit breaker opened after otel export: 1 o...
Sep 08 03:51:41 info signal-intake.service {"time":"2026-09-08T03:51:41.158385812Z","level":"INFO","msg":"telemetry per...
Sep 08 03:51:40 info agent-i.service 2026/09/08 03:51:40 exporter: endpoint recovered, resuming normal delivery
Sep 08 03:51:40 info agent-i.service 2026/09/08 03:51:40 export error (source=container.network.io_usage.cx.byte...
Sep 08 03:51:40 info agent-i.service 2026/09/08 03:51:40 exporter: circuit breaker opened after otel export: 2 o...
Sep 08 03:51:37 info agent-i.service 2026/09/08 03:51:37 exporter: endpoint recovered, resuming normal delivery
Sep 08 03:51:37 info agent-i.service 2026/09/08 03:51:37 export error (source=system.network.dropped): otel expo...
Sep 08 03:51:37 info agent-i.service 2026/09/08 03:51:37 exporter: circuit breaker opened after otel export: 1 o...
Sep 08 03:51:35 info agent-i.service 2026/09/08 03:51:35 exporter: endpoint recovered, resuming normal delivery
Sep 08 03:51:35 info agent-i.service 2026/09/08 03:51:35 export error (source=system.network.errors): otel expo...
Sep 08 03:51:35 info agent-i.service 2026/09/08 03:51:35 exporter: circuit breaker opened after otel export: 1 o...
Sep 08 03:51:35 info signal-intake.service {"time":"2026-09-08T03:51:35.158911894Z","level":"INFO","msg":"telemetry pe...
Sep 08 03:51:33 info agent-i.service 2026/09/08 03:51:33 exporter: endpoint recovered, resuming normal delivery
Sep 08 03:51:33 info agent-i.service 2026/09/08 03:51:33 export error (source=system.network.packets): otel expo...
Sep 08 03:51:33 info agent-i.service 2026/09/08 03:51:33 exporter: circuit breaker opened after otel export: 1 o...
Sep 08 03:51:33 info signal-intake.service {"time":"2026-09-08T03:51:33.193396221Z","level":"INFO","msg":"telemetry pe...
Sep 08 03:51:31 notice kernel audit: type=1400 audit(1788839491.620:14149): apparmor="DENIED" operation="...
Sep 08 03:51:31 notice kernel audit: type=1400 audit(1788839491.620:14148): apparmor="DENIED" operation="...
Sep 08 03:51:31 notice kernel audit: type=1400 audit(1788839491.614:14147): apparmor="DENIED" operation="...
Sep 08 03:51:31 notice kernel audit: type=1400 audit(1788839491.614:14146): apparmor="DENIED" operation="...
Sep 08 03:51:31 notice kernel audit: type=1400 audit(1788839491.595:14145): apparmor="DENIED" operation="...
Sep 08 03:51:31 notice kernel audit: type=1400 audit(1788839491.595:14144): apparmor="DENIED" operation="...
Sep 08 03:51:31 notice kernel audit: type=1400 audit(1788839491.593:14143): apparmor="DENIED" operation="...
Sep 08 03:51:31 notice kernel audit: type=1400 audit(1788839491.576:14142): apparmor="DENIED" operation="...
Sep 08 03:51:31 notice kernel audit: type=1400 audit(1788839491.576:14141): apparmor="DENIED" operation="...
Sep 08 03:51:31 notice kernel audit: type=1400 audit(1788839491.574:14140): apparmor="DENIED" operation="...
Sep 08 03:51:31 warning kernel kauditd_printk_skb: 41 callbacks suppressed
Sep 08 03:51:31 info signal-intake.service {"time":"2026-09-08T03:51:31.158302158Z","level":"INFO","msg":"telemetry pe...
Sep 08 03:51:28 info agent-i.service 2026/09/08 03:51:28 exporter: endpoint recovered, resuming normal delivery
Sep 08 03:51:28 info agent-i.service 2026/09/08 03:51:28 export error (source=container.blockio.io_service_bytes...
Sep 08 03:51:28 info agent-i.service 2026/09/08 03:51:28 exporter: circuit breaker opened after otel export: 1 o...
Sep 08 03:51:26 info agent-i.service 2026/09/08 03:51:26 exporter: endpoint recovered, resuming normal delivery
Sep 08 03:51:26 info agent-i.service 2026/09/08 03:51:26 export error (source=container.cpu.usage.kernelmode): o...
Sep 08 03:51:26 info agent-i.service 2026/09/08 03:51:26 exporter: circuit breaker opened after otel export: 1 o...
Sep 08 03:51:25 info signal-intake.service {"time":"2026-09-08T03:51:25.158949008Z","level":"INFO","msg":"telemetry pe...
Sep 08 03:51:24 info agent-i.service 2026/09/08 03:51:24 exporter: endpoint recovered, resuming normal delivery

tab screen enter detail f stop following u/p/b/t filter / search x export ? help q quit
following 1 new
```

```
tui-logs journalctl everything
journal: open entries: 500 on disk: 2.5G backend: journald 255
[1 entries] 2 stats 3 storage
Sep 08 06:08:26 info agent-i.service

2026/09/08 06:08:26 exporter: endpoint recovered, resuming normal delivery

Fields
unit          agent-i.service
identifier    agent-i
priority      6
pid           947
uid           995
gid           986
command       agent-i
executable    /usr/local/bin/agent-i
command line  /usr/local/bin/agent-i -config /etc/agent-i/agent.yaml
transport     stdout
host          1b-172-31-36-199
boot          b04a324dec4b4a86a2733dcd39a41b8a
machine       ec2dba4220898fd123415cefed121140
syslog facility 3
selinux context unconfined:
cgroup        /system.slice/agent-i.service
slice         system.slice
invocation    ba5a5bcl1a82949cdbaaa4f8d91be3520

Everything else this entry carried
_CAP_EFFECTIVE      0
_RUNTIME_SCOPE      system
_STREAM_ID           235a189e45cd4b9e9beb0a6f665e26d7

Show it with journalctl
$ journalctl --no-pager -o verbose -n 1 --cursor s=fb8ddb6093f34c4da6348718b432d741;i=3fed1c;b=b04a324dec4b4a86a2733dcd39a41b8a;m=3d4f7744e;t=65af29015435a;x=65071f997...

The window on screen came from
$ journalctl --no-pager -o json -n 500

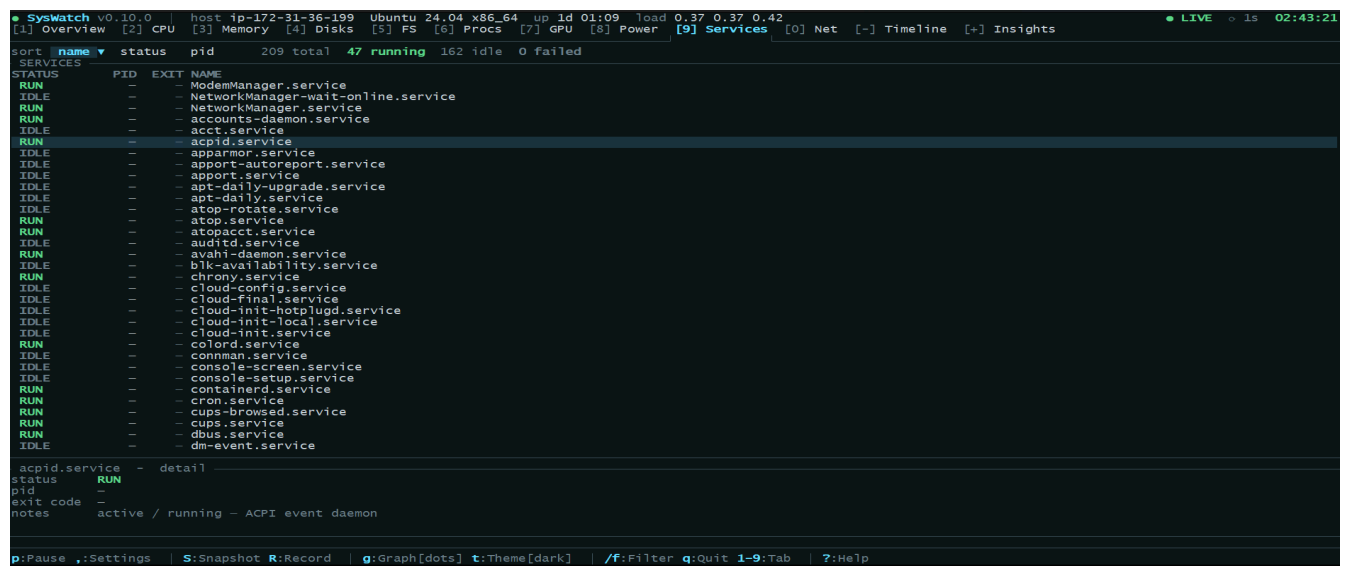
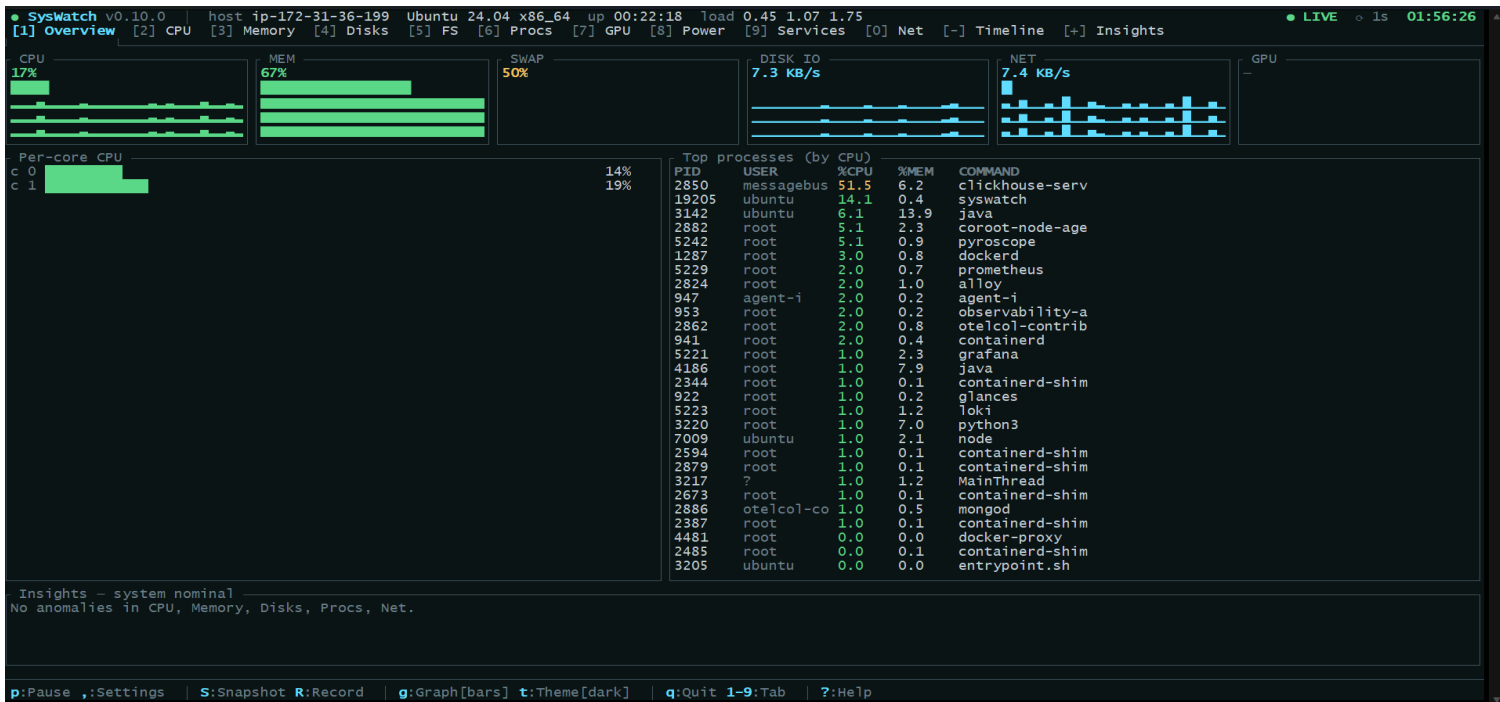
tab screen enter detail f follow u/p/b/t filter / search x export ? help q quit
1-34 of 34 lines · esc to go back
```

SysWatch: **syswatch**

Gives a single live view of Linux CPU, memory, disk, network, processes, and services.

Main problem: Quickly identifies failed services, resource issues, and system health problems.

Production benefit: Enables faster troubleshooting and helps prevent server/application downtime.



Tui-disk: tui-disk

Shows all disks, partitions, mounts, usage, and health in one simple view.

Production benefit: Quickly finds full disks, mount problems, and storage issues before they cause outages.

```
tui-disk lsblk via /usr/bin/sudo -n
disks: 1 mounts: 83 health: all passed backend: util-linux 2.39.3

NAME                SIZE  FSTYPE USED MOUNTPOINT HEALTH
loop0               28.2M squashfs 100% /snap/amazon-ssm-agent/13009
loop1               28.4M squashfs 100% /snap/amazon-ssm-agent/13349
loop2                4K squashfs 100% /snap/bare/5
loop3               2.2M squashfs 100% /snap/bottom/781
loop4               1.9M squashfs 100% /snap/btop/1004
loop5              55.5M squashfs 100% /snap/core18/2999
loop6              74M squashfs 100% /snap/core22/2411
loop7              74M squashfs 100% /snap/core22/2437
loop8              66.8M squashfs 100% /snap/core24/1643
loop9              972K squashfs 100% /snap/dust/19
loop10             164.8M squashfs 100% /snap/gnome-3-28-1804/198
loop11             91.7M squashfs 100% /snap/gtk-common-themes/1535
loop12             37M squashfs 100% /snap/semgrep/13
loop13             50.1M squashfs 100% /snap/snapd/27591
loop14             50.1M squashfs 100% /snap/snapd/27710
nvme0n1             163G
├─nvme0n1p1         162G ext4 64% /
├─nvme0n1p14         4M
└─nvme0n1p15       106M vfat 6% /boot/efi
nvme0n1p16         153M ext4 100% /snap

enter detail a add to fstab tab screen / filter R reload ? help q quit
20 devices - enter for detail - ? for help
```

```
tui-disk lsblk via /usr/bin/sudo -n
disks: 1 mounts: 83 health: all passed backend: util-linux 2.39.3
1 devices 3 btrfs 4 health 5 space

MOUNT POINT SOURCE POINT TYPE FSTAB USED
/dev/mqueue mqueue transient
/proc proc transient
/proc/sys/fs/binfmt_misc proc systemd-1 transient
/proc/sys/fs/binfmt_misc binfmt_misc transient
/sys sysfs transient
/sys/kernel/security securityfs transient
/sys/fs/cgroup cgroup2 transient
/sys/fs/pstore pstore transient
/sys/firmware/efi/efivars efivarfs transient 3%
/sys/fs/bpf bpf transient
/sys/kernel/debug debugfs transient
/sys/kernel/tracing tracefs transient
/sys/fs/fuse/connections fusectl transient
/sys/kernel/config configfs transient
/run tmpfs transient
/run/lock tmpfs transient
/run/user/1000 tmpfs transient
/run/user/115 tmpfs transient
/run/snapd/ns tmpfs [snapd/ns] transient
/run/docker/netns/default nsfs [net: [4026531833]] nsfs transient
/run/docker/netns/4641fb86723b nsfs [net: [4026533713]] nsfs transient
/run/docker/netns/51cf6dc4417 nsfs [net: [4026533502]] nsfs transient
/run/docker/netns/a36f924dc3b0 nsfs [net: [4026532929]] nsfs transient
/run/docker/netns/7f81d27cf246 nsfs [net: [4026533248]] nsfs transient
/run/docker/netns/e29760043056 nsfs [net: [4026533650]] nsfs transient
/run/docker/netns/7ab6b95fd9ba nsfs [net: [4026534028]] nsfs transient
/run/docker/netns/adee98cbea96 nsfs [net: [4026532866]] nsfs transient
/run/docker/netns/f6217d82df2c nsfs [net: [4026532803]] nsfs transient
/run/docker/netns/b04c0b4a9e6c nsfs [net: [4026533060]] nsfs transient
/run/docker/netns/6cd078663cf3 nsfs [net: [4026533376]] nsfs transient
/run/docker/netns/bb5afb31e15c nsfs [net: [4026533185]] nsfs transient
/run/docker/netns/b2d112c6041f nsfs [net: [4026533439]] nsfs transient
/run/docker/netns/6d0347d93574 nsfs [net: [4026533122]] nsfs transient
/run/docker/netns/9f7b42758f26 nsfs [net: [4026532992]] nsfs transient
/run/docker/netns/5534d5c30ea9 nsfs [net: [4026533133]] nsfs transient
/run/docker/netns/d4a69f222304 nsfs [net: [4026533579]] nsfs transient
/run/docker/netns/14a24d691185 nsfs [net: [4026533776]] nsfs transient
/run/docker/netns/f1be704f38bc nsfs [net: [4026533965]] nsfs transient
/run/docker/netns/599745ea6e77 nsfs [net: [4026533902]] nsfs transient
/run/docker/netns/632b002ff8c4 nsfs [net: [4026533839]] nsfs transient
/snap/amazon-ssm-agent/13009 /dev/loop0 squashfs transient 100%
/snap/amazon-ssm-agent/13349 /dev/loop1 squashfs transient 100%

enter detail m mount u umount e edit fstab a add tab screen / filter R reload ? help q quit
83 mounts - enter for detail - ? for help
```

Superfile is a simple TUI file manager that brings a visual file-browser experience directly into the terminal.

-  **Easy navigation** — browse files and folders quickly.
-  **File management** — copy, move, rename, and delete files from one interface.
-  **Less typing** — reduces the need for repeated `ls`, `cd`, `cp`, `mv`, and `rm` commands.

